

# Smartphone Cameras: It's All About What Clicks

If you thought checking the megapixels of a smartphone's camera is enough, think again! There's more to it...

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A lot of people select a smartphone based on its camera's quality. For them the smartphone serves as a replacement for their camera, while also allowing them to use the phone. From measly VGA cameras, these devices have now come up to almost DSLR quality, and the quality is improving further day by day. Remember the time when a 5-megapixel camera on a mobile phone used to be a big thing? Well, today a 5-megapixel camera is either a front camera or a budget smartphone's camera.

When buying a smartphone for its camera, you would naturally be looking at the megapixel count. While this gives an idea of picture quality, two cameras with the same megapixel count may produce different picture qualities. Take the case of 16-megapixel cameras in Samsung Galaxy S5 and Micromax Canvas

Knight; Galaxy S5 produces much better pictures than Canvas Knight.

## Features to look for

Smartphone cameras' quality depends on more than just megapixels. Of course the megapixels do make a difference to the quality of the pictures you want to click, but this is surely not the only thing to look for. Megapixels just indicate how sharp an image you can take with the camera. It also gives an idea of how much you can enlarge the image without pixelation. But there are other important features to look out for.

**Image sensor.** An image sensor is where the light falls through the lens to form picture. If image sensor size is big, the picture will be more detailed. So, if you have a camera with higher number of megapixels but a smaller image sensor, the quality of image may get compromised.

**ISO or sensitivity of the camera.** This is yet another detail that buyers

ignore while buying a camera-enabled phone. High ISO setting means you can take clear images even in low lighting situation without any hassle. With high ISO, the camera electrically stimulates the sensor to brighten the image.

**Aperture.** Aperture refers to size of lens-opening that allows light to fall on the sensor. So, if your smartphone promises awesome photography in low light, remember that it has nothing to do with megapixels, but the aperture of your camera. An aperture of f2.2 or f1.8 is a common standard these days.

Let us now take a look at the kind of devices available in India.

## Budget range

Let us consider smartphones priced at ₹10,000 to ₹15,000, as phones that boast of 12- megapixel plus camera are usually not available at a price below this. The Micromax Canvas Magnus and Canvas Turbo are two good examples of phones

## SMARTPHONE CAMERAS TO CHOOSE FROM

|        | Xiaomi Mi 3                                                                         | Karbbonn Titanium Octane Plus                                                       | Micromax Canvas Turbo 250                                                           | Lenovo S850                                                                         | Micromax Canvas Gold                                                                | Micromax Canvas Knight A 350                                                        | HTC Desire 816                                                                      | Samsung Galaxy K Zoom                                                               |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|        |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| Price  | ₹ 13,999                                                                            | ₹ 14,999                                                                            | ₹ 14,729                                                                            | ₹ 14,890                                                                            | ₹ 19,730                                                                            | ₹ 18,990                                                                            | ₹ 23,399                                                                            | ₹ 29,999                                                                            |
| Camera | 13-megapixel                                                                        | 16-megapixel                                                                        | 13-megapixel                                                                        | 13-megapixel                                                                        | 16-megapixel                                                                        | 16-megapixel                                                                        | 13-megapixel                                                                        | 20.7-megapixel                                                                      |
|        | Sony Xperia Z1 Compact                                                              | Nokia Lumia 1520                                                                    | Samsung Galaxy Note 3                                                               | Nokia Lumia 1020                                                                    | LG G3                                                                               | HTC One (M8)                                                                        | Sony Xperia Z2                                                                      | Samsung Galaxy S5                                                                   |
|        |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| Price  | ₹ 28,990                                                                            | ₹ 36,990                                                                            | ₹ 37,499                                                                            | ₹ 43,390                                                                            | ₹ 43,999                                                                            | ₹ 39,600                                                                            | ₹ 41,990                                                                            | ₹ 33,500                                                                            |
| Camera | 20.7-megapixel                                                                      | 20-megapixel                                                                        | 13-megapixel                                                                        | 41-megapixel                                                                        | 13-megapixel                                                                        | 4-Ultrapixel                                                                        | 20 MP                                                                               | 16-megapixel                                                                        |

The prices mentioned here are from various e-commerce portals and are subject to change.